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EXPERIMENT 8
Workflow using Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To create and implement a workflow in Zoho Creator that automates actions in a business application when a form event occurs, and to understand the different workflow options available in the platform using a Loan Application as the example.

2. Introduction

A workflow in Zoho Creator is a set of automated actions that run when a specified event takes place, such as a record being created or edited, a date being reached, or a user approving a request. Workflows reduce manual work, keep data consistent and enforce business rules without requiring users to perform every step themselves. They are built in the Workflow section of the application using a drag-and-drop builder, and Deluge scripts can be added for custom logic.

Zoho Creator offers several workflow options: **Form workflows**, **Schedules**, **Approvals**, **Payments**, **Blueprints**, **Batch workflows** and **Functions**. In this experiment a form workflow named **EMI_Status_Automation** is created and enabled on the EMI Payment Tracking Form of the Loan Application.

3. Objectives of the Study

- To learn the meaning and importance of workflows in Zoho Creator.
- To understand the steps involved in creating a form workflow and setting its trigger.
- To study the different workflow options such as Schedules, Approvals, Blueprints and Functions.
- To understand how forms with and without workflows are listed and managed.
- To create a working workflow based on a real-world loan management application.

4. Procedure

1 Sign in to the Zoho Creator platform and open the **Loan Application**.

2 Click **Workflow** in the top menu and select the **Form workflows** tab.

3 In the left panel, note the *Forms with workflows* and *Forms without workflows* lists and select the **EMI Payment Tracking Form**.

4 Click **New Workflow** and enter the workflow name **EMI_Status_Automation**.

5 Choose the form event **Created or Edited** and set it to execute on **Validations on form submission**.

6 Add the required action (for example, a Deluge script that sets the EMI payment status) so that the workflow shows **1 Action**.

7 Save the workflow and make sure its status is **Enabled**.

8 Review the other tabs – Schedules, Approvals, Payments, Blueprints, Batch workflows and Functions – to see where more automation can be added.

9 Open the application in Access mode, add or edit an EMI record and check that the workflow runs.

10 Make necessary changes to the workflow, if required, and publish the application.

5. Illustrative Example

Consider a Loan Management System developed using Zoho Creator, where information about loan applications, disbursements, EMI payments, applicants and branches is maintained in forms. Bank staff should not have to update the EMI payment status manually every time a record is entered.

5.1 Implementation using Zoho Creator

A form workflow named **EMI_Status_Automation** is created for the EMI Payment Tracking Form. It is triggered when a record is created or edited, on validations during form submission, and performs 1 action automatically. The workflow is enabled and was created on 30-Oct-2026. The Loan Disbursement Form and Loan_Application_Form also have workflows, whereas Applicant_Details and Branches have none.

S.No	Item	Value / Description
1	Workflow Name	EMI_Status_Automation
2	Form	EMI Payment Tracking Form
3	Trigger	Created or Edited → Validations on form submission
4	Details	1 Action
5	Status	Enabled
6	Created On	30-Oct-2026
7	Forms with workflows	EMI Payment Tracking Form, Loan Disbursement Form, Loan_Application_Form
8	Forms without workflows	Applicant_Details, Branches

The workflow options available in the Workflow section are:

S.No	Workflow Option	Use in the Loan Application
1	Form workflows	Run on form events such as create or edit, e.g., setting EMI status automatically.
2	Schedules	Run at set dates or times, e.g., a daily check for overdue EMI payments.
3	Approvals	Route a loan application to a manager for approval or rejection.
4	Payments	Connect a payment gateway to collect EMI payments online.
5	Blueprints	Model loan stages (Submitted, Document Verification, Credit Check) as a process.
6	Batch workflows	Process many records together, e.g., updating all pending disbursements.

S.No	Workflow Option	Use in the Loan Application
7	Functions	Store reusable Deluge code, such as an EMI calculation, that workflows can call.

5.2 Illustrative Workflow Design

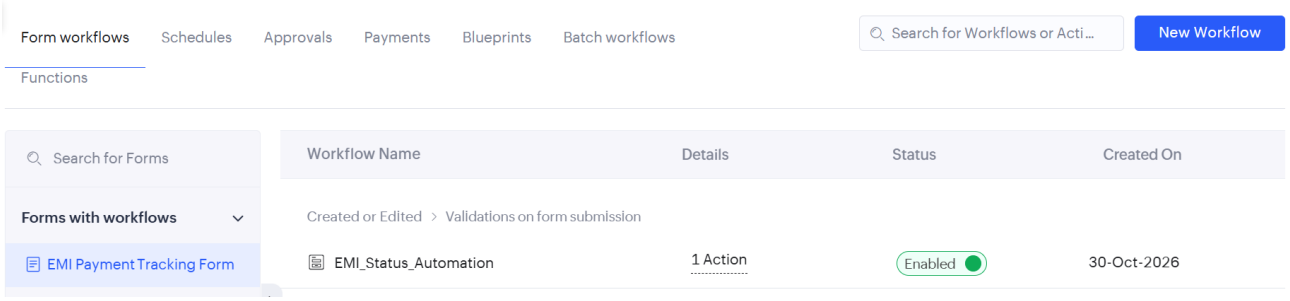


Figure 1: Form workflows tab showing the EMI_Status_Automation workflow

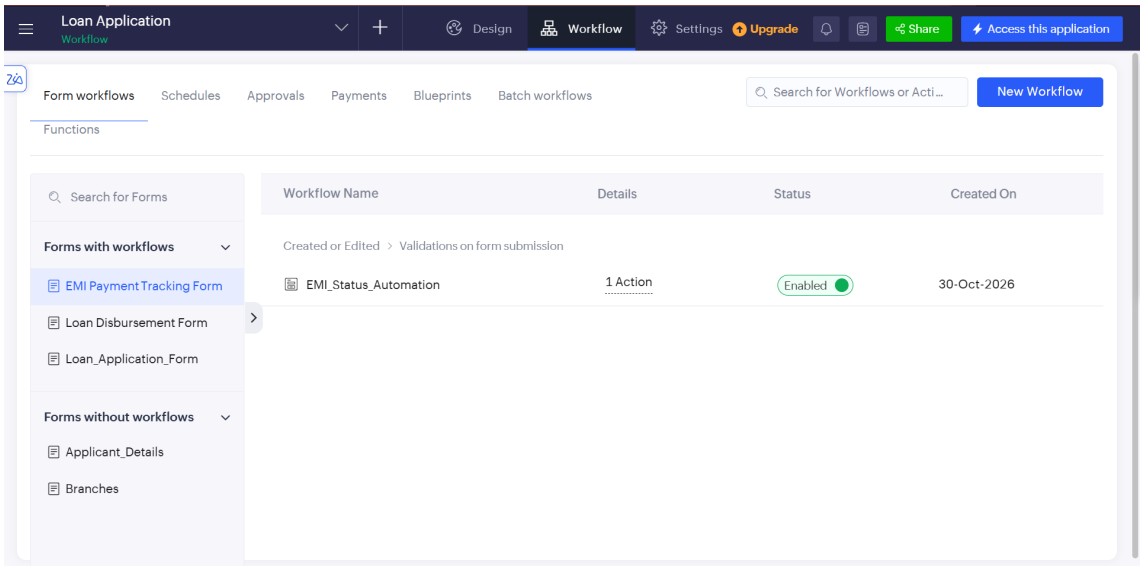


Figure 2: Workflow section of the Loan Application (complete view)

6. Advantages and Limitations

6.1 Advantages

- Automates repetitive tasks and saves time for users.
- Reduces manual errors and keeps application data consistent.
- Offers several workflow options for events, schedules, approvals, payments and processes.
- Workflows can be enabled or disabled easily using the status toggle.
- Uses a drag-and-drop builder, with Deluge scripting needed only for advanced logic.

6.2 Limitations

- Complex workflows require knowledge of Deluge scripting.
- Too many workflows on one form can make debugging difficult.
- Some options, such as Payments and Blueprints, need extra configuration or a paid plan.
- Poorly designed workflows can slow down form submission.
- Available workflow features depend on the capabilities of the Zoho Creator platform.

7. Result

The experiment was successfully completed by learning the process of creating workflows in Zoho Creator and implementing the form workflow EMI_Status_Automation for a Loan Application. The implementation showed how events, triggers and actions can be combined to automate business processes with minimal manual effort.